

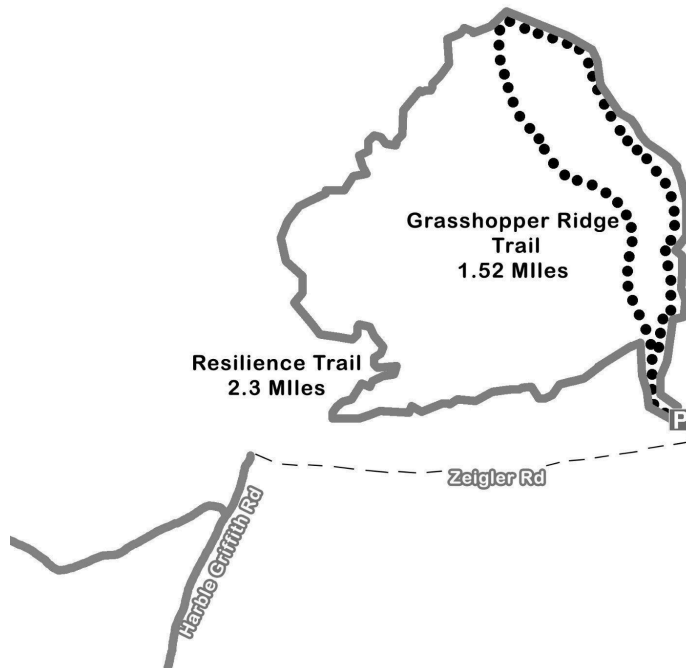


VISITING & HIKING

Resilience Preserve Size: 525 acres

The Arc of Appalachia's operations are 100% supported by private donations. If you love what we do, [please support us](#), so that our wildlands preservation work and trail stewardship can continue.

Resilience protects a large hill flanked with unbroken forests surrounding an open meadow ridgetop. The preserve is one of the largest roadless regions of the county, includes mature timberlands, and is one of Ohio's few dark sky preserves. Resilience harbors an exceptional abundance of wildlife.



Dogs are permitted at Resilience on a six-foot leash. Please see [Hiking Arc Preserves](#) for more dog-friendly trails.

Hiking Difficulty - moderate to easy, so long as hikers understand this is a moderately long walk. Resilience is rolling land, but not rocky. Ascents and descents are frequent but short-lasting.

You are entering a highly protected nature preserve. Regulations exist to protect the preserve's natural communities from the impact of public visitors. Please follow these regulations to leave the preserve as pristine as you found it. Remain on trails at all times and walk in single file to protect the bulbs of native wildflowers bordering the trail - bulbs that are very vulnerable to soil compaction. Do not disturb, pick, or collect flowers, plants, rocks, or wildlife. Hunting, caving, fishing, trail biking, rock climbing, wading, campfires, and swimming are prohibited.

Interpretive kiosk: An interpretive kiosk is planned but not yet installed. We encourage you to download the prepared trail guide and bring it with you to the preserve so that you can follow the trail routes.

Trails are open year-round from sunrise to sunset. Note: Parking lots are not winter-maintained. Please stay safe by not hiking during trails during periods of heavy rain, ice, and snow. Also note that trails are closed during the annual deer management hunt which takes place on 1) the Monday through Sunday following Thanksgiving, and 2) the Saturday and Sunday before Christmas.

Hiking Trail Descriptions:

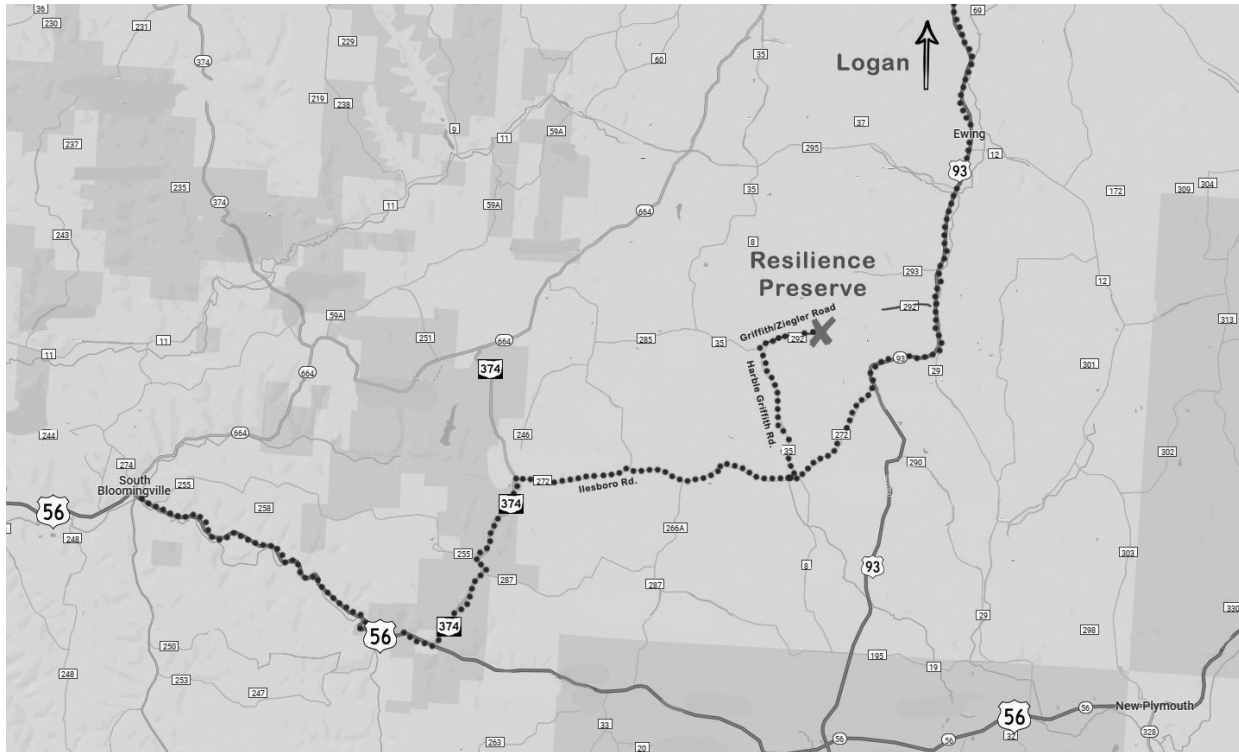
Resilience Trail. At 2.3 miles, Resilience is the longer of the two loop trails offered in the preserve. Both trails leave the trailhead along the same route, continuing together through the eastern section of the ridgetop's woodlands. When the two trails separate, Grasshopper Ridge Trail completes its loop in the ridgetop's meadows whereas the Resilience Trail continues to wind through a mosaic of forest types. The woodlands include mature oak and hickory forests that haven't been disturbed for 80 or more years. Wildflowers here include perfoliate bellflower, black snakeroot, and wild comfrey. The trail also passes through younger successional hardwood forests, and stands of Virginia Pine that are reclaiming the open fields. Resilience Preserve has bountiful vernal pools left behind by the property's earlier coal mining and reclamation activities. Look for salamander larvae with their external gills, wood frog and American toad tadpoles, and other aquatic life.

Grasshopper Ridge Trail is a 1.52 Mile Loop Trail. The Grasshopper Ridge Trail begins in the woodlands and ends in the ridgetop's meadows in an area that was once the bustling industrial scene of a strip mining operation for coal. The vast open landscape is surprisingly pleasing to the human eye and features many panoramic vistas as well as boasting remarkably high populations of Henslow's and grasshopper sparrows. In the Virginia Pines that rim the meadow, listen for the songs of the pine warblers and yellow-breasted chats. Watch for flocks of barn swallows weaving aerial ballets above your head as your feet kick up insects, and box turtles hiding among the grasses. Admire the turtles, but please leave them be. They have strong homing instincts and moving them threatens their health and survival.

Natural History. The vast rolling fields that were once strip-mined are now home to many field-loving birds and support the largest breeding populations of Henslow's sparrows we have ever witnessed. The flanks that surround the ridgetop and dominate the acreage of the property are entirely wooded with oaks, hickories, and maples. On the interface between forest and field, groves of Virginia scrub pines grow, boasting yellow-breasted chats and pine warblers. The numerous catch basins on the property - built to slow down acid run-off and contain its precipitates - have long ago been bypassed by the streams, creating basins that have filled up instead with fresh rainwater becoming vernal pools, teeming with frogs, and salamanders. Wherever these pools and marshes received enough sun, the rare, acid-tolerant netted chain fern grew in large colonies—many aquatic plants proliferated in these wetlands, along with thick mats of sphagnum moss. Because the preserve is remote and without roads, Resilience is a dark sky refuge.

Preserve history: The property represents two acquisitions: the main purchase of 513 acres, and the very generous donation of an adjacent 12-acre property by Emily Foster, now deceased. "Foster's Retreat" now serves as the preserve's trailhead. Resilience was strip-mined in the 1980's, during which time the soil and upper bedrock layers were removed to expose the coal. During reclamation, the rock layers were pushed back in place, but because they were broken, crushed, and jumbled up, rainfall proceeded to percolate through them like water through coffee grounds. The run-off waters pick up natural minerals in unnaturally high concentrations, minerals such as aluminum, sulfuric acid, manganese, copper, lead, arsenic, and mercury. These minerals create very acidic, toxic stream conditions that are an antithesis to higher life forms. As the runoff waters become diluted with fresh water and are oxygenated downstream, colorful minerals precipitate out. The silver-gray precipitates are tell-tale aluminum compounds, while the signature reds are compounds of iron. Although the streams of Resilience will heal in time, it will take thousands if not tens of thousands of years. We have paid a large environmental price for the privilege of our country's earlier dependency on coal. Today many streams in Southeastern Ohio are too acidic to support life.

DIRECTIONS:



Location: West leg of Ziegler Rd in SE Hocking County east of Hocking Hills State Park. Please note that Ziegler Road was severed by coal mining operations in the 1980's and remains so to this day. To access the preserve, navigate from the west, following the directions below.

Directions From South Bloomingville: Follow OH-56 east from South Bloomingville for 4.1 miles. Turn left or north on OH-374. Continue for 2.1 miles and then turn right on Ilesboro Rd. Continue for 3.1 miles and turn left on Harble Griffith Road. Continue for 1.5 miles. Turn right onto Griffith Rd which almost immediately becomes Ziegler Road (veer right). Continue on Ziegler Rd for 0.5 miles until it dead ends at the signed trailhead on your left. You will note a private residence on your right on Ziegler Road. DO NOT PARK on the road opposite this private development or anywhere else along Ziegler Road. If the trailhead parking lot is full, please come back another time.

From Logan: Take OH-93 South out of Logan and continue on the route for 9.0 miles. Make a slight right onto Ilesboro Road and continue for 1.4 miles. Turn right onto Harble Griffith Road and follow for .5 miles. Turn right onto Griffith Rd which almost immediately becomes Ziegler Road (veer right). Continue on Ziegler Rd for 0.5 miles until it dead ends at the signed trailhead on your left. You will note a private residence on your right on Ziegler Road. DO NOT PARK on the road opposite this private development or anywhere else along Ziegler Road. If the trailhead parking lot is full, please come back another time.